

The Woman's Wallet

SHARE OF EXPENDITURE

	WORKING SINGLE	ALL MARRIED	WORKING MARRIED WITH NO CHILDREN	WORKING MARRIED WITH DEPENDENT CHILDREN	WORKING MARRIED WITH INDEPENDENT CHILDREN	HOMEMAKERS
Apparel and accessories	27	23	28	21	26	25
Gifts/books/music	19	15	17	15	14	15
Eating out/ordering in	19	12	14	12	11	12
Financial products and services	13	23	14	24	25	22
Mobile phone/camera/handycam	7	4	5	4	4	3
Movies/theatre/outdoor entertainment	5	5	6	5	7	6
Expenditure on personal grooming	5	3	4	3	2	3
Average EMI paid	2	11	7	13	6	10
Jewellery	2	3	4	3	4	3
Others	1	1	0	1	2	1

All values are in percentages. Source: The Indian Consumer Trends 2006-07 survey by The Knowledge Company, Technopak of 25,000 consumers aged between 12 and 70 from Sec A, B and C households, across 50 centres, representing the top 784 urban towns in India.

Married working women with no children spend 14% of their income on financial products. The figure almost doubles in case of working married women with dependent children at 24%.

Two to tango

For a working woman with no children, part of the Double Income No Kids universe, financial freedom comes easy. She dabbles in stocks, takes care of insurance premiums and pays off EMIs, while the husband spends on the household.

Shweta Agarwal, 27, Accounts Manager, Wunderman.

Savings: 40 per cent of the monthly income.

Agarwal has been married for four years but despite having a house to run, she finds that there's more money to spend than when she was single. "With both of us working, we don't worry about how much we're spending, as long as there's something being tucked away," says the 27-year-old accounts manager of a marketing communication firm. Agarwal parks 40 per cent of her income in her bank account, is paying off the EMI on a flat the couple bought in Delhi two years ago, makes payments on insurance premiums and dabbles in stocks through mutual funds, while her husband takes care of the household expenses. The rest is play money, which she likes spending on home accessories, travelling and gifts for family and friends. "I'm trying to strike a balance and save as well because once children come into picture, I know we won't be able to save as much as we can do now," she says. But even though she's not a shopaholic, Agarwal enjoys having "curtains to match my walls", buying books and music or signing up for salsa classes.

